20. The three engraved boulders are described in Hultzsch (1925): xii–xiii.

21. For an excellent analysis of the dispatch pattern of the rock edicts, Falk (2006): 111–12.

22. In the case of the major rock edict fragments at Kandahar, it seems that these were actually on a stone slab.

23. This is the translation of Lines II–V of the first rock edict at Erragudi as provided by Sircar (1979): 14. That the sort of festive gathering—samaja—where animals were sacrificed is what Ashoka did not want held is implied here since it is an adjunct of the earlier sentence that no living being should be killed for sacrifice. See Bose (1998): 111–12.

24. Falk (2006): 111.

25. Chakrabarti (2011): 52.

26. Thomas and Joglekar (1994): 196–8.

27. Kane (1997): 781 notes this statement from Vanaparva 208.11–12 of the *Mahabharata*.

28. Ibid.: 775, quoting *Satapatha Brahmana* XI.6.1.3.

29. Lines VI to IX of Erragudi Rock Edict I, in Sircar (1979): 14.

30. Lines II, III, V, and VI of Erragudi Edict V, ibid.: 23.

31. Line XV of Erragudi Edict V, in Sircar (1979): 24.

32. K. Rajan's excavations at Kodumanal in this regard have been most crucial. The excavator and his team have obtained three AMS dates—275 BCE, 330 BCE, and 408 BCE (all uncalibrated)—from well-stratified layers. These come from layers which have yielded a considerable number of potsherds bearing inscriptions in the Tamil-Brahmi script. Around 100 such potsherds have been found in 2012 alone, while, on the whole, the excavations have yielded 500 Tamil-Brahmi inscribed sherds. The names on these potsherds, in several instances, have affiliations with names from the North. The excavations have also yielded a couple of sherds of North Black Polished Ware which is associated with the first phase of the early historical period in North and Central India. Considering that in earlier seasons at Kodumanal silver punch-marked coins were found, there is now excellent evidence to argue that this commercial centre had well-established trade and cultural contacts with the middle Gangetic plains in the fifth century BCE. Rajan and Yatheeskumar (2010–12). Also see Rajan, Selvakumar, Ramesh, and Balamurugan (2013) for scientific dates from Porunthal.

33. Line II, Erragudi Edict IV. See Sircar (1979): 27.

34. Lines II–III, Erragudi Edict VII, ibid.: 25